

Leavings Are Tough...



Matt & Heather Headley

Apr 17, 2025



Leavings Are Tough...

Hey friends,

Matt here—writing this through tears, surrounded by drying books and daffodils.

Last month, I stepped away from my role as a local church pastor to become a full-time flower farmer. It's been scary, sacred, and surprisingly healing.

Honestly? I felt like a lunatic. And I'm pretty sure I wasn't the only one wondering if I'd gone off the rails again. 🤔

Because the truth is, last year... was a wreck.

#weknowthis

I [shared my story](#) about wrestling with clinical depression. And in many ways, it nearly took me out. The old version of Matt didn't make it—but something new is emerging. And this Patreon is part of that resurrection.



🌸 From Pastor to Pasture

For over two decades, I led worship, preached sermons, and pastored congregations.

Now, I steward sheep. Literally. And goats. And chickens. My congregation is a mix of animals, wildflowers, our four kids, and the kind souls who support this little oasis of beauty and belonging on the Chief Ladiga Trail.

The word *pastoral* means something new now.



I first heard it used differently in a conversation with Trevor and Joanna Mann of WaldenFARMacy—two friends and permaculture mentors. They were talking about animal husbandry and agroforestry: integrating animals, grasses, and trees to create a thriving, regenerative ecosystem.

Turns out, there's still a shepherd in me.

Just with a shovel instead of a stole.

Maundy Thursday Musings

Today is Maundy Thursday—the day of “mandate,” when Jesus said:

“A new commandment I give you: Love one another as I have loved you.”

It's a day to release what's dead or dying. To trust the soil with our egos and our expectations—and wait for the miracle of green shoots.

“Every new beginning comes from some other beginning's end.”

—Semisonic (by way of Emerson... by way of Jesus)

A Trampoline Full of Books

This week, I emptied my old office. Twenty years of books, sheet music, journals, and Sunday bulletins. I left them in the rain by accident. Now they're drying on the kids' trampoline.

Poetic, right?

#nailinthecoffin



What Others Are Saying

If you're curious about my journey through depression, from pulpit to peony, I wrote a piece for The Anniston Star last year:

 [Read the Anniston Star article](#)

Join Me

This post marks the start of my Patreon. I'll be sharing:

- Behind-the-scenes peeks at life on Headley Farm
- Reflections like this one—spiritual, gritty, and grounded
- Updates on our Trail Porch shop + book project
- Stories about how healing blooms in unlikely places

If this resonates with you—stick around. Maybe even share this with a friend who's navigating their own resurrection.

And as always:

May you find beauty in what's fading.

May death do its holy work.

May you bloom again.

With gratitude,

—Matt

Headley Farm 🌻

🎵 Today's Anthem: "Heavy" by Birdtalker

Tags

depression farming holy week theology

In collection

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1 post

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Posted Apr 17, 2025 at 7:00 AM



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Hey Friends, Heather and I recorded a brief update video to catch up on June and look ahead to July. We are so grateful for your support and

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I Had a Pulpit—And I Still Do

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